



Little Lab Coats

Variation Can Help Survival

Life Science — Traits for Survival | Unit 3, Lesson 1 of 6



Grade: Grade 3



Duration: 45–60 minutes



Subject: Life Science — Traits for Survival



In the right environment, a variation can become an advantage.



NGSS Standard:

3-LS4-2 — Use evidence to construct an explanation for how the variations in characteristics among individuals of the same species may provide advantages in surviving, finding mates, and reproducing.



Learning Objective

Students will explain that variation in traits can give some individuals a survival edge in a specific environment.



Camouflage and Staying Hidden

Life Science — Traits for Survival | Unit 3, Lesson 2 of 6



Grade: Grade 3



Duration: 45–60 minutes



Subject: Life Science — Traits for Survival



Camouflage works best when the trait matches the background.



NGSS Standard:

3-LS4-2 — Use evidence to construct an explanation for how the variations in characteristics among individuals of the same species may provide advantages in surviving, finding mates, and reproducing.

GRADE 3 LIFE SCIENCE PATH

Lesson 1

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Lesson 3

Lesson 4

Lesson 5

Lesson 6



Learning Objective

Students will use evidence to explain how camouflage trait differences can help organisms avoid predators or capture prey.



Little Lab Coats

Beaks, Mouths, and Getting Food

Life Science — Traits for Survival | Unit 3, Lesson 3 of 6



Grade: Grade 3



Duration: 45–60 minutes



Subject: Life Science — Traits for Survival



Different feeding traits work best with different foods.



NGSS Standard:

3-LS4-2 — Use evidence to construct an explanation for how the variations in characteristics among individuals of the same species may provide advantages in surviving, finding mates, and reproducing.

GRADE 3 LIFE SCIENCE PATH

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Learning Objective

Students will compare feeding traits and explain how certain variations may help individuals get food in different settings.



Movement Traits in Different Places

Life Science — Traits for Survival | Unit 3, Lesson 4 of 6



Grade: Grade 3



Duration: 45–60 minutes



Subject: Life Science — Traits for Survival



Movement traits become advantages when they match the environment.



NGSS Standard:

3-LS4-2 — Use evidence to construct an explanation for how the variations in characteristics among individuals of the same species may provide advantages in surviving, finding mates, and reproducing.

GRADE 3 LIFE SCIENCE PATH

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Learning Objective

Students will explain how trait differences in movement can help organisms in different environments.



Little Lab Coats

Traits That Help Find Mates or Reproduce

Life Science — Traits for Survival | Unit 3, Lesson 5 of 6



Grade: Grade 3



Duration: 45–60 minutes



Subject: Life Science — Traits for Survival



Some traits help reproduction by attracting partners or helpers.



NGSS Standard:

3-LS4-2 — Use evidence to construct an explanation for how the variations in characteristics among individuals of the same species may provide advantages in surviving, finding mates, and reproducing.

GRADE 3 LIFE SCIENCE PATH

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Learning Objective

Students will explain how some trait variations can help organisms attract mates, protect offspring, or reproduce successfully.



Little Lab Coats

Construct an Explanation From Evidence

Life Science — Traits for Survival | Unit 3, Lesson 6 of 6



Grade: Grade 3



Duration: 45–60 minutes



Subject: Life Science — Traits for Survival



Strong explanations connect variation, context, and advantage.



NGSS Standard:

3-LS4-2 — Use evidence to construct an explanation for how the variations in characteristics among individuals of the same species may provide advantages in surviving, finding mates, and reproducing.

GRADE 3 LIFE SCIENCE PATH

Lesson 1

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Lesson 6



Learning Objective

Students will use evidence from multiple unit investigations to explain how trait variation may provide advantages in surviving, finding mates, and reproducing.